

"The hobbit"

Often called "the hobbit" due to its small size, remains of this human relative were found on an island off the coast of Indonesia, where the water is very deep.

Archaeologists are trying to work out how these people got to the island and why they were so small.

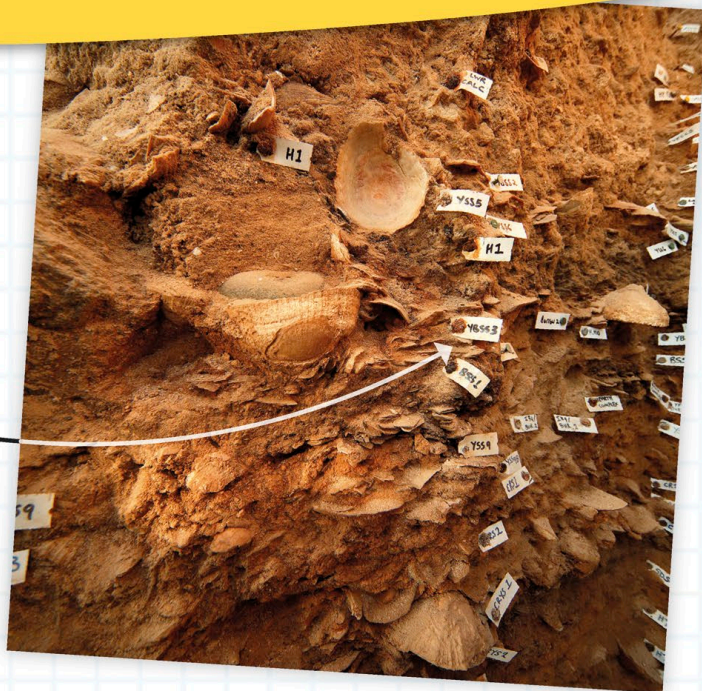


"The hobbit" skull

Markers show rock layers for studying (stratigraphy)

Digging deep

A basic rule of archaeology is that older stuff sits under newer stuff. Think of a messy bedroom with clothes piled on top of toys. The toys on the bottom of the pile have probably been there longer than the clothes on top! In this picture, the shells at the bottom have been there longer than the shells at the top.



Cheddar Man

Cheddar Man is the name given to a body found in a cave in Cheddar Gorge, England, a place famous for its cheese. The caves in the gorge have a constant temperature, making them ideal for aging cheese as well as providing a comfortable home for Stone Age humans.



Cheddar Man's skeleton



REALLY?

DNA evidence shows that **Cheddar Man** is a distant ancestor of some people living there today.